November 8 Lesson Plan: "A New Spirit Will I Put within You"

Reading: Ezekiel 1-3; 33-34; 36-37; 47

Lesson emphasis: Jesus Christ does not abandon us when life feels spiritually dry, scattered, or broken. Through Him, we can repent, receive a new heart, be gathered, and find healing.

Come, Follow Me lesson: November 2-8, 2026

Lesson overview

Ezekiel was a priest and prophet living in Babylonian captivity. Far from Jerusalem and the temple, he still saw the glory of the Lord. His message is deeply hopeful: the Lord can seek scattered sheep, forgive those who repent, replace a stony heart with a new heart, give life to what seems dead, and bring healing like a river flowing from the temple.

For a 25-minute class, let students share what they noticed during the week first. Then choose **three or four** of the passages below - not all of them. A helpful thread to return to is:

> *What does Jesus Christ do when a person feels distant, spiritually dry, discouraged, or scattered?*

Key scriptures and discussion questions

Ezekiel 3:17 - The Lord's watchman

> ***17*** *Son of man, I have made thee a watchman unto the house of Israel: therefore hear the word at my mouth, and give them warning from me.*

What it teaches: Prophets hear the Lord's word and warn His people out of love. Their counsel helps us see spiritual dangers we might not recognize by ourselves.

Questions:

- What responsibilities does a watchman have in this verse?
- How is a living prophet like a watchman - not merely predicting danger, but helping us choose safety and peace?
- What recent prophetic counsel has helped you see a danger or opportunity more clearly?
- How can we respond to warnings with faith rather than fear?

Ezekiel 34:11-16 - Jesus Christ is the Shepherd who seeks us

> ***11*** *For thus saith the Lord God; Behold, I, even I, will both search my sheep, and seek them out.* ***12*** *As a shepherd seeketh out his flock in the day that he is among his sheep that are scattered; so will I seek out my sheep, and will deliver them out of all places where they have been scattered in the cloudy and dark day.* ***13*** *And I will bring them out from the people, and gather them from the countries, and will bring them to their own land, and feed them upon the mountains of Israel by the rivers, and in all the inhabited places of the country.* ***14*** *I will feed them in a good pasture, and upon the high mountains of Israel shall their fold be: there shall they lie in a good fold, and in a fat pasture shall they feed upon the mountains of Israel.* ***15*** *I will feed my flock, and I will cause them to lie down, saith the Lord God.* ***16*** *I will seek that which was lost, and bring again that which was driven away, and will bind up that which was broken, and will strengthen that which was sick: but I will destroy the fat and the strong; I will feed them with judgment.*

What it teaches: The Savior actively searches for, gathers, feeds, heals, and strengthens His sheep. He notices both those who are lost and those who have been driven away.

Questions:

- Which of the Shepherd's actions in verses 11-16 stands out to you most? Why?
- What is the difference between someone who is "lost" and someone who has been "driven away"? How might the Savior minister differently to each?
- What could a "good pasture" and "good fold" represent in our lives?
- How can we help the Savior seek, welcome, bind up, or strengthen someone this week?

Ezekiel 33:10-19 and 36:26-28 - Repentance brings a new heart

> ***Ezekiel 33:11*** *Say unto them, As I live, saith the Lord God, I have no pleasure in the death of the wicked; but that the wicked turn from his way and live: turn ye, turn ye from your evil ways; for why will ye die, O house of Israel?* ***Ezekiel 36:26*** *A new heart also will I give you, and a new spirit will I put within you: and I will take away the stony heart out of your flesh, and I will give you an heart of flesh.* ***27*** *And I will put my spirit within you, and cause you to walk in my statutes, and ye shall keep my judgments, and do them.* ***28*** *And ye shall dwell in the land that I gave to your fathers; and ye shall be my people, and I will be your God.*

What it teaches: The Lord wants us to turn and live. Repentance is more than stopping a behavior; through Jesus Christ it becomes a change of heart and a gift of His Spirit.

Questions:

- What do the Lord's words "turn ye, turn ye" teach about His desire for us?
- What might a "stony heart" look like in ordinary life? What helps a heart become more tender?
- What is the difference between trying to change alone and allowing the Savior to give us a new heart?
- How do the sacrament, prayer, scripture study, temple worship, and service invite the Spirit to change us?

Ezekiel 37:1-6, 11-14 - The Lord gives new life

> ***1*** *The hand of the Lord was upon me, and carried me out in the spirit of the Lord, and set me down in the midst of the valley which was full of bones,* ***2*** *And caused me to pass by them round about: and, behold, there were very many in the open valley; and, lo, they were very dry.* ***3*** *And he said unto me, Son of man, can these bones live? And I answered, O Lord God, thou knowest.* ***4*** *Again he said unto me, Prophesy upon these bones, and say unto them, O ye dry bones, hear the word of the Lord.* ***5*** *Thus saith the Lord God unto these bones; Behold, I will cause breath to enter into you, and ye shall live:* ***6*** *And I will lay sinews upon you, and will bring up flesh upon you, and cover you with skin, and put breath in you, and ye shall live; and ye shall know that I am the Lord.* ***11*** *Then he said unto me, Son of man, these bones are the whole house of Israel: behold, they say, Our bones are dried, and our hope is lost: we are cut off for our parts.* ***12*** *Therefore prophesy and say unto them, Thus saith the Lord God; Behold, O my people, I will open your graves, and cause you to come up out of your graves, and bring you into the land of Israel.* ***13*** *And ye shall know that I am the Lord, when I have opened your graves, O my people, and brought you up out of your graves,* ***14*** *And shall put my spirit in you, and ye shall live, and I shall place you in your own land: then shall ye know that I the Lord have spoken it, and performed it, saith the Lord.*

What it teaches: The vision points to the Lord's power to restore Israel, raise the dead, and bring new spiritual life where hope feels lost. The gathering of Israel is a work of restoration on both sides of the veil.

Questions:

- What feelings might the dry bones represent: discouragement, spiritual distance, grief, sin, or something else?
- What does it mean to "hear the word of the Lord" when hope feels low?
- Where have you seen the Lord bring new life, faith, or hope to an individual, a family, or a ward?
- How does this vision strengthen your faith in the Resurrection and in the gathering of Israel?

Ezekiel 37:15-23 - The Bible and Book of Mormon gather us to Christ

> ***15*** *The word of the Lord came again unto me, saying,* ***16*** *Moreover, thou son of man, take thee one stick, and write upon it, For Judah, and for the children of Israel his companions: then take another stick, and write upon it, For Joseph, the stick of Ephraim, and for all the house of Israel his companions:* ***17*** *And join them one to another into one stick; and they shall become one in thine hand.* ***21*** *And say unto them, Thus saith the Lord God; Behold, I will take the children of Israel from among the heathen, whither they be gone, and will gather them on every side, and bring them into their own land:* ***22*** *And I will make them one nation in the land upon the mountains of Israel; and one king shall be king to them all: and they shall be no more two nations, neither shall they be divided into two kingdoms any more at all:* ***23*** *Neither shall they defile themselves any more with their idols, nor with their detestable things, nor with any of their transgressions: but I will save them out of all their dwellingplaces, wherein they have sinned, and will cleanse them: so shall they be my people, and I will be their God.*

What it teaches: The "stick of Judah" and "stick of Joseph" are commonly understood as the Bible and Book of Mormon. Together they testify of Jesus Christ, help gather Israel, and strengthen covenant unity.

Questions:

- Why is it a blessing to have both the Bible and the Book of Mormon?
- What has one of these books of scripture taught you about Jesus Christ that the other one helps confirm or deepen?
- According to verses 21-23, what is the Lord trying to accomplish through the gathering of Israel?
- How can sharing scripture or a testimony of Christ help gather someone to Him?

Ezekiel 47:1-12 - Healing waters flow from the temple

> ***1*** *Afterward he brought me again unto the door of the house; and, behold, waters issued out from under the threshold of the house eastward: for the forefront of the house stood toward the east, and the waters came down from under from the right side of the house, at the south side of the altar.* ***2*** *Then brought he me out of the way of the gate northward, and led me about the way without unto the utter gate by the way that looketh eastward; and, behold, there ran out waters on the right side.* ***3*** *And when the man that had the line in his hand went forth eastward, he measured a thousand cubits, and he brought me through the waters; the waters were to the ankles.* ***4*** *Again he measured a thousand, and brought me through the waters; the waters were to the knees. Again he measured a thousand, and brought me through; the waters were to the loins.* ***5*** *Afterward he measured a thousand; and it was a river that I could not pass over: for the waters were risen, waters to swim in, a river that could not be passed over.* ***7*** *Now when I had returned, behold, at the bank of the river were very many trees on the one side and on the other.* ***9*** *And it shall come to pass, that every thing that liveth, which moveth, whithersoever the rivers shall come, shall live: and there shall be a very great multitude of fish, because these waters shall come thither: for they shall be healed; and every thing shall live whither the river cometh.* ***12*** *And by the river upon the bank thereof, on this side and on that side, shall grow all trees for meat, whose leaf shall not fade, neither shall the fruit thereof be consumed: it shall bring forth new fruit according to his months, because their waters they issued out of the sanctuary: and the fruit thereof shall be for meat, and the leaf thereof for medicine.*

What it teaches: The water flowing from the temple symbolizes the life and healing that come from Jesus Christ and from temple covenants. Even places that seem unable to sustain life can be healed by His power.

Questions:

- What details show that the river brings increasing life and healing?
- Why might the water begin at the temple? What could that teach about the Savior and temple covenants?
- What are some "dry" places in our lives, homes, or relationships that need the Lord's living water?
- How have worship, covenants, family history, or temple service helped bring peace and healing?

25-minute lesson plan

0:00-3:00 - Welcome and purpose

You might say:

> *"Ezekiel taught people who had been taken from their homes and temple. Yet the Lord showed them that He could still be with them, give them a new heart, gather them, and bring life where they felt hopeless. Today, listen for what these scriptures teach about Jesus Christ's power to renew and heal us."*

3:00-6:00 - Student preparation and sharing

Invite students to look at their scriptures or notes and answer:

1. Which image or verse from Ezekiel stayed with me this week?
2. What did it teach me about Jesus Christ?
3. What is one thought I would like someone else to hear?

Invite several voluntary responses. Let students respond to one another before adding your own comment.

6:00-17:00 - Choose two or three passages for discussion

Choose based on the class's comments:

- **Prophetic counsel and ministering:** Ezekiel 3:17 and 34:11-16.
- **Repentance and a changed heart:** Ezekiel 33:11 and 36:26-28.
- **Hope and the gathering of Israel:** Ezekiel 37:1-14 and 15-23.
- **Temple healing:** Ezekiel 47:1-12.

Read the verses and ask only one or two questions from each section. The goal is not to cover every symbol; it is to help students identify what the Savior offers them.

17:00-21:00 - Whole-class connection

Write these phrases where the class can see them:

- The Shepherd seeks.
- The Savior changes hearts.
- The Lord gives new life.
- The temple brings healing.

Ask:

> *"Which of these promises feels most needed in the world - or in our own lives - right now?"*

Follow with:

> *"What could we do this week to receive that help or help someone else receive it?"*

21:00-24:00 - Personal application

Invite students to silently choose one action:

- Follow a specific piece of prophetic counsel.
- Ask the Savior to soften or renew your heart.
- Read from both the Bible and Book of Mormon this week.
- Reach out to someone who may feel lost, driven away, broken, or sick.
- Prepare for temple worship or family history work with a desire for healing.

24:00-25:00 - Conclusion

You might conclude:

> *"The Lord did not abandon Israel in exile, and He does not abandon us. Jesus Christ is the Shepherd who seeks us, the Savior who gives us a new heart, the source of new life, and the living water that brings healing."*

Optional resources

- **"The Book of Mormon Gathers Scattered Israel"** (1:31): Best paired with Ezekiel 37:15-23.
- **"And the River Will Grow"** (3:43): Best paired with Ezekiel 47:1-12.
- **"Watchman on the Tower"** (4:17): Best paired with Ezekiel 3:17 and 33:1-5.
- Elder Dale G. Renlund, "Family History and Temple Work: Sealing and Healing": A helpful resource for Ezekiel 47.
- Elder Gerrit W. Gong, "Ministering": A helpful resource for Ezekiel 34.

Teaching reminders

- Do not try to cover every passage; allow the students' preparation to guide the focus.
- Treat Ezekiel's images as invitations to see Jesus Christ, not puzzles that must all be solved.
- Do not press students to share personal struggles. Keep application personal and voluntary.
- Make room for silence after the application invitation.